Virgil, and Milton.'

Probably long before Kalidasa, another famous play was produced—Shudraka's 'Mrichhkatika' or the Clay Cart, a tender rather artificial play, and yet with a reality which moves us and gives us a glimpse into the mind and civilization of the day.

About 400 **A.C**., also during the reign of Chandragupta II, yet another notable play was produced, Vishaka-datta's 'Mudra-Rakshasa' or the signet ring. This is a purely political play with no love motive or story from mythology. It deals with the times of Chandragupta Maurya, and his chief minister, Chanakya, the author of the ArthashSstra, is the hero. In some ways it is a remarkably topical play to-day.

Harsha, the king, who established a new empire early in the seventh century **A.C**., was also a playwright and we have three plays written by him. About 700 **A.C**. there lived Bhavabhuti, another shining star in Sanskrit literature. He does not yield himself easily to translation for his beauty is chiefly of language, but he is very popular in India, and only Kalidasa has precedence over him. Wilson, who used to be professor of Sanskrit at Oxford University, has said of these two: 'It is impossible to